> While I was with Bhindranwale, (former) Central Minister Swaran Singh barged in. As I was sitting on the only chair in the room, he squatted on the floor. Before I could offer him the chair, he remarked that he preferred to sit on the floor in the presence of the Sant.

Obviously, Nayar did not know the real purpose behind Swaran Singh's visit that day. Swaran Singh's words were meant to massage Bhindranwale's ego, as Singh was about to seek a favour from him as soon as everyone in the room left. About a year before Nayar passed away in 2018, in an executive committee meeting of the Bhai Veer Singh Sahitya Sadan (of which both of us were members), I told Nayar about the real purpose of Singh's visit that day. Nayar, who knew Swaran Singh very well, said that from Swaran Singh's behaviour that day he could not gauge the real importance of that visit.

When everyone in that room had left, Swaran Singh, on Bhindranwale's request, moved to the chair. He then told Bhindranwale that as one of his well-wishers he had come to discuss with him a very important matter. Singh went on to say that inaction on the part of the government towards his gun-toting, motorcycle-riding 'army' should not be construed as its weakness. If the government so desired, they could put a stop to their activities in no time. Further, if he and the Akalis continued with their agitations, it would bring great harm to Punjab in general and Sikhs in particular. Singh told Bhindranwale that his advice was that before the government was compelled to take any drastic action against him and his armed men, he should withdraw his agitation and move back to his gurudwara at Chowk Mehta and concentrate on religious activities.

Singh ended by saying that with the approval of Indira Gandhi he was trying to work out a compromise that could help the Akalis withdraw their agitation. He told Bhindranwale that if he had any reasonable demand of his own, he should feel free to discuss it with him and, as far as possible, he would try to accommodate it once a compromise formula with the Akalis was worked out.